

Javier Saldana

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SKILLS

Languages: Java, Python, SQL

Frameworks & Protocols: Spring Boot, gRPC, protobuf, OAuth 2.0 / OIDC

Infrastructure & DevOps: Kubernetes, Docker, Helm, Istio, Terraform, Argo CD (GitOps), GitHub Actions, Jenkins, AWS / EKS

Data & Observability: PostgreSQL, Pulsar, Kafka, Redis, Prometheus, OpenTelemetry, Grafana, OpsGenie

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Fair Isaac Corp. (FICO)

New York, NY

Lead Software Engineer, Platform Engineering

July 2022 - Present

- Own the evolution of Identity and Access Management (IAM) microservices on Spring-Boot, serving as the authentication and authorization foundation for the FICO Platform, consumed by 15+ internal platform services and onboarding 3+ enterprise financial institutions processing 1M+ daily auth requests with 99.98% uptime SLA
- Built the authorization backbone for the FICO Platform, an OPA bundle distribution system delivering sub-millisecond decentralized policy evaluation to 30+ microservices via a shared client library, with a dual-sidecar bootstrap pattern that eliminated cold-start authorization failures
- Shipped a custom Kubernetes Operator using Java Operator SDK with CRD-based RBAC definitions, reconciliation loops, and admission webhooks to validate group-to-role, permission-to-role, and permission-to-resource mappings at deploy time across 20+ microservices, cutting provisioning from 2 hours to ~8 minutes and preventing misconfigurations before runtime
- Designed and led a distributed, time-ordered UID generation service producing 10K+ UIDs/sec, identifying and resolving a clock-skew vulnerability at 1M+ QPS that would have caused ID collisions in production and contributed to a filed patent on distributed UID generation
- Drove a service-by-service migration to replace shared database proxy layers with direct client connections, cutting P95 latency by 45% and producing a reusable migration framework (connection pooling, retry logic, health checks) adopted by 6 engineering teams

Fair Isaac Corp. (FICO)

Los Angeles, CA

Software Engineering Intern

June 2021 - August 2021

- Designed a cost-optimized, event-driven data replication system on AWS (S3, EC2, Lambda) to mirror production-scale datasets across accounts, removing the need for parallel storage of identical data
- Built Python-based ETL pipelines via AWS SDK to filter, deduplicate, and reorganize 5+ TB of data, reducing unnecessary storage by 40% and cutting data-retrieval latency by 30%

SOFTWARE PROJECTS

StatStack | *Python, Django REST, React, PostgreSQL, Redis, Docker*

- Built a data aggregation and analytics service ingesting 100K+ records across 1,600+ NFL games over 6 seasons (2020–2025), serving 20+ REST endpoints for rankings, head-to-head comparisons, and matchup analysis
- Optimized PostgreSQL query plans by eliminating N+1s via `select_related/prefetch_related`, pushing aggregations to the database with `annotate/aggregate` expressions, and layering per-endpoint Redis caching (5–15 min TTLs)
- Built an ML prediction pipeline using an ensemble of 3 models (RandomForest, GradientBoosting, Ridge) trained on 44 engineered features per game to predict winners, spreads, and totals with confidence scoring and simulation validation

Compass | *Python, Anthropic Claude API, SQLite, Click*

- Built a CLI accountability agent using structured tool use via the Anthropic API, generating schema-validated JSON tasks with deadline awareness across multi-turn discovery conversations (up to 5 turns)
- Designed a two-layer persistent context architecture (global user profile partitioned by life domain + per-goal SQLite state) enabling cross-session personalization without redundant prompting
- Implemented graceful rejection flows (regeneration, extended discussion, goal modification) preventing dead-end interactions in daily context-aware check-ins referencing active goals and overdue tasks

EDUCATION

New York University - *B.S. Computer Science, Minor in Data Science and Mathematics*

New York, NY